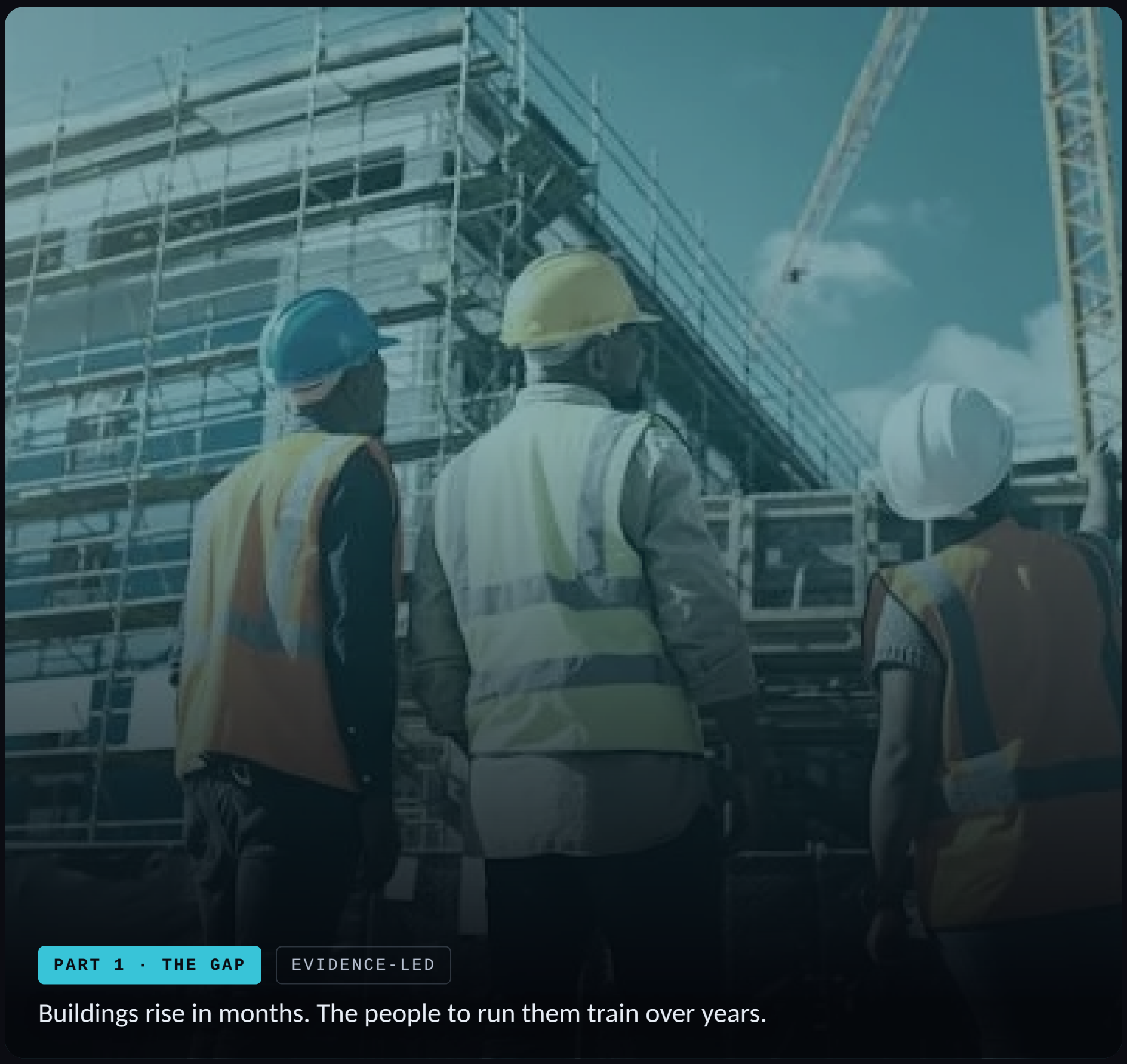
Kenya is building data centres. Who will run them?

Monday introduced the people behind the facilities. Part 1 asks whether the training pipeline is keeping pace with the build-out.



PART 1 · THE GAP

EVIDENCE-LED

Buildings rise in months. The people to run them train over years.

WHAT WE CAN VERIFY

The build-out is real, tracked and published

27 **facilities tracked** across Kenya in the DC254 census

20 **operational** today, verified per record

42.9 MW **built capacity** at operational sites

10.5 MW **published live IT load**, operator-reported

> **Every number on this slide is on the record, with sources and verification dates.**

The announced pipeline

230

MEGAWATTS
ANNOUNCED
PIPELINE

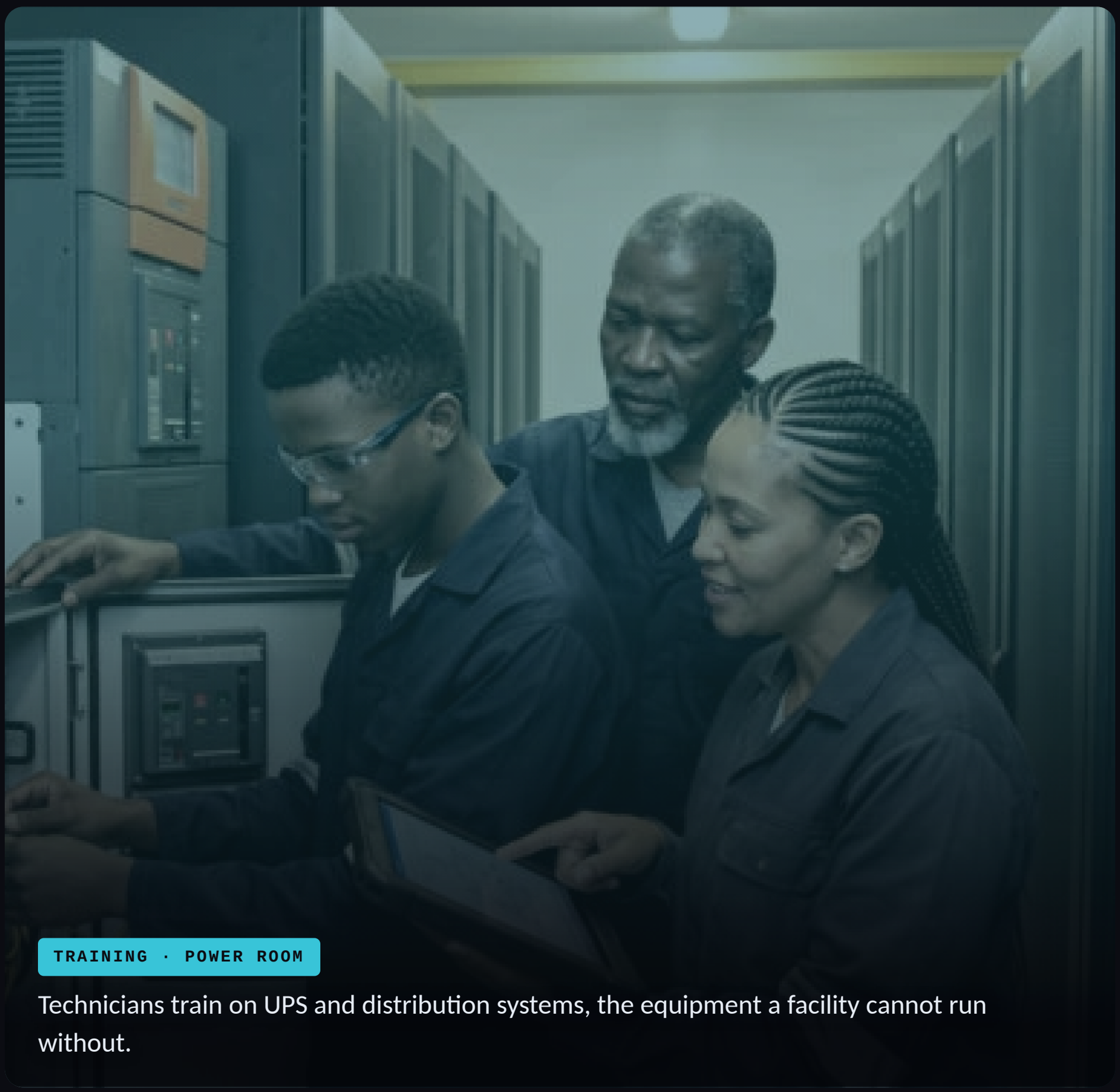
77 MW **under construction** right now

53 MW **committed** projects

100 MW **early stage** announcements

> **Announced is not the same as operating. Commissioning is what turns this line into buildings with staff inside.**

Every one of those buildings needs people to run it

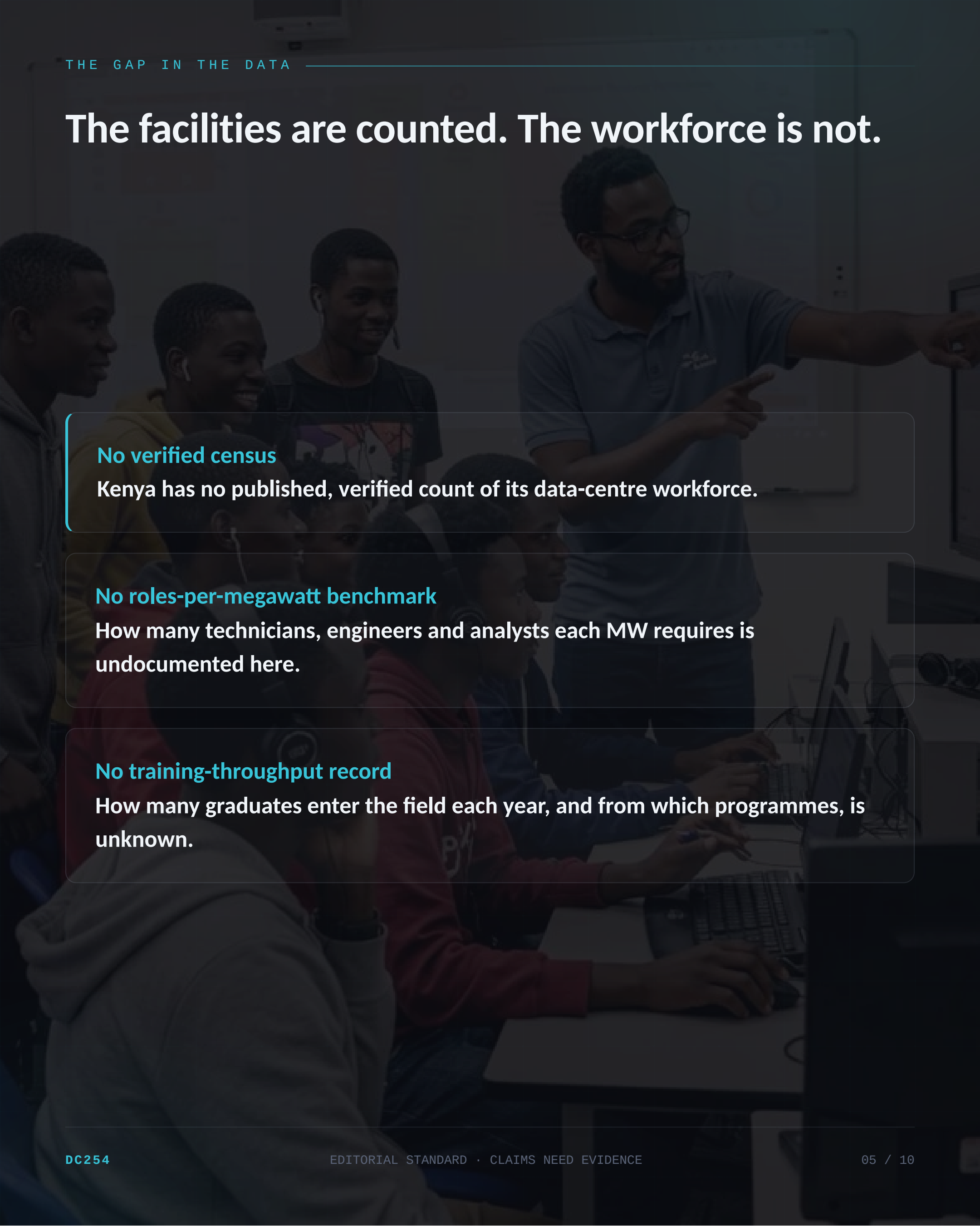


TRAINING · POWER ROOM

Technicians train on UPS and distribution systems, the equipment a facility cannot run without.

Power · Cooling · Networks · Security · Cloud · Operations - every role from Monday's carousel must be staffed at each new site.

The facilities are counted. The workforce is not.



No verified census

Kenya has no published, verified count of its data-centre workforce.

No roles-per-megawatt benchmark

How many technicians, engineers and analysts each MW requires is undocumented here.

No training-throughput record

How many graduates enter the field each year, and from which programmes, is unknown.

HONEST QUESTIONS

What nobody can answer for Kenya yet

01 · Scale

How many additional people will the pipeline require if even part of it commissions?

02 · Skills

Which roles are hardest to develop or recruit for, and why?

03 · Speed

Can local training supply keep pace with the commissioning calendar?

> Anyone quoting you a precise skills-gap number today is guessing. That includes us.

Signals exist. Proof does not. Yet.

Training partnerships

Operators and institutions have begun announcing programmes and collaborations.

Job activity

Data-centre roles appear in Kenyan job listings, but no systematic count exists.

Curriculum interest

Universities and TVETs are engaging with industry on digital-infrastructure skills.

> Each signal is worth tracking. **Signals are not a measured pipeline.**

Commissioning day needs staff on site

Months to commission a building that is already under construction

Years to train the electrical, mechanical, network and operations staff it needs

> **If even part of the 230 MW pipeline commissions, Kenya will need more people to run its data centres than it employs today. The staffing question starts before ribbon-cutting day, or it becomes a crisis on it.**

Help DC254 measure the gap instead of debating it

01 **Employer interviews** - what operators actually struggle to hire

02 **Job-listing analysis** - a systematic record of DC roles posted in Kenya

03 **Curriculum review** - what universities, TVETs and academies teach today

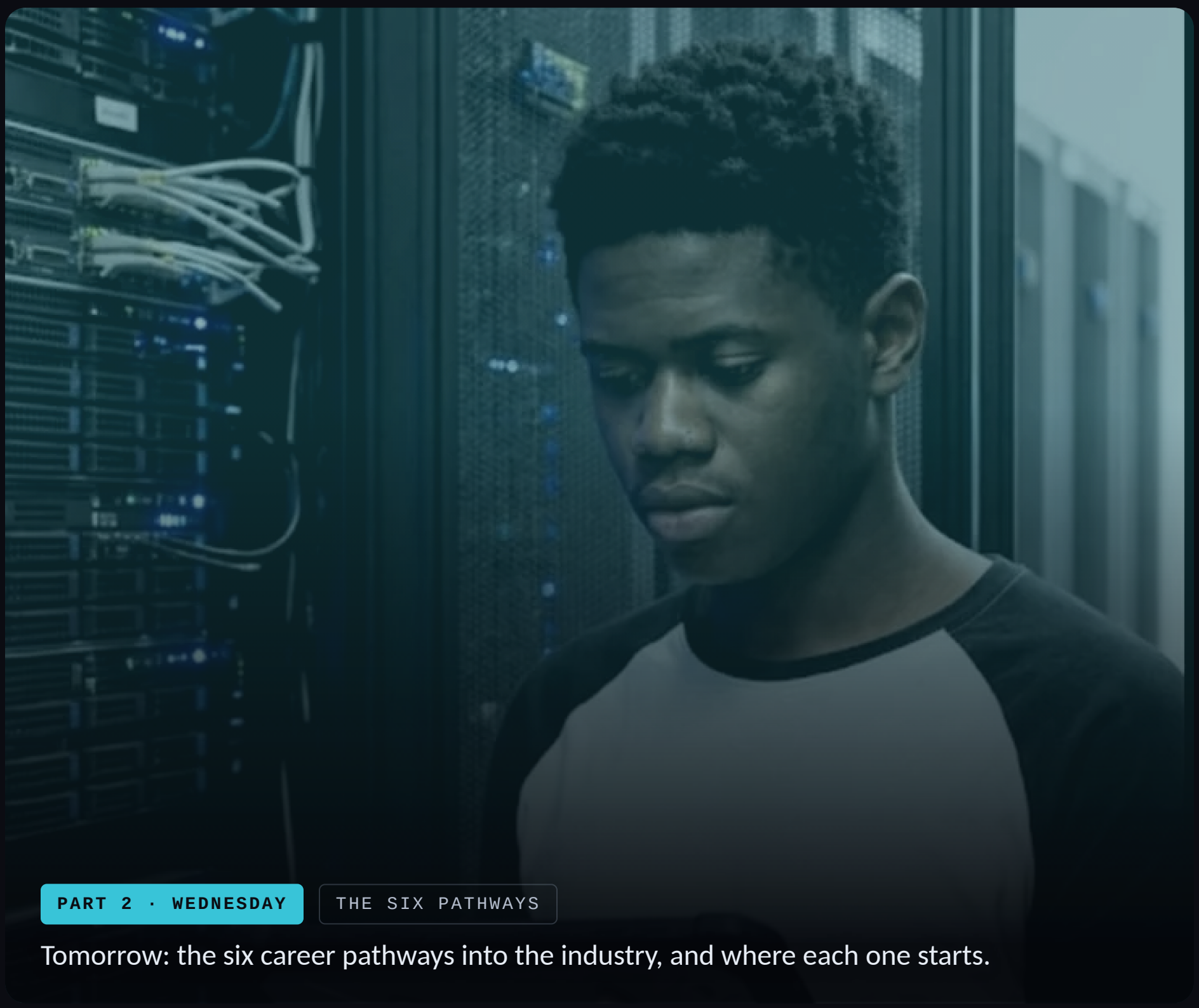
04 **Workforce conversations** - the people already on the floor

> **The series exists to collect evidence, then publish a workforce briefing on it.**

YOUR TURN

Which skills are hardest to develop or recruit for?

If you work in the industry or teach it, your answer becomes part of the evidence base. Comment here or contact DC254 directly.



PART 2 · WEDNESDAY THE SIX PATHWAYS

Tomorrow: the six career pathways into the industry, and where each one starts.

CAREERS COVERAGE

data-centers-254.vercel.app/careers